

There Is No Gatekeeper.

Whoever picks up the phone is the perfect person.

Session 30 · Tuesday 10 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

IN THIS TOOLKIT

- 01 The party mindset
- 02 "You're the perfect person" — the line
- 03 Stage 1, 2, 3 responses
- 04 Be correctable — the desire to be right
- 05 Treat reception as the boss's partner
- 06 Daily reference card

01 · THE MENTAL MODEL

The Party Mindset

Same party. Same people. Two completely different nights.

REP A · GATEKEEPER MINDSET

"This is going to be a pack of difficult people."

- ✗ Scans the room confirming the thesis
- ✗ Every unfriendly face = data
- ✗ One friendly face goes unnoticed
- ✗ Leaves feeling "I was right"
- ✗ Has confirmed they don't like parties

REP B · OPPORTUNITY MINDSET

"There's at least one person here I'll enjoy talking to."

- ◆ Scans the room for the right person
- ◆ Unfriendly faces = move on
- ◆ Finds someone to vibe with
- ◆ Leaves with a connection
- ◆ Comes back next week

THE COLD CALL IS THE PARTY

The receptionist who shuts you down isn't a gatekeeper. She's the one person at the party you didn't connect with. The next one might be.

THE TELL

Reps who burn out treat every closed door as evidence the party is hostile. Reps who last are still scanning the room on call 50.

02 · THE OPENER

"You're the Perfect Person"

Works whether they really are or aren't.

USE IT IN THE FIRST 30 SECONDS

"I think you're the perfect person to speak to about this."

Said warmly. Like you mean it. Because you do.

OUTCOME 1**They actually are**

They feel respected. You skipped the offensive "is the owner there?" opener. Conversation starts on solid ground.

→ **You found the buyer.**

OUTCOME 2**They aren't**

People love to correct. "Actually you need Bob in sales." You now have the buyer's name from someone inside.

→ **You got the buyer's name.**

WHY THIS WORKS

ASYMMETRIC: There's real upside in both outcomes and no real downside. The rep declares the person on the phone IS the right one. If they aren't, the correction comes for free, with dignity intact on both sides.

THE OFFENSIVE VERSION TO AVOID

"Is the owner there?" — implies the person on the phone isn't important.

03 · THINK BEFORE YOU SPEAK

Stage 1, 2, 3 Responses

What you say. What they hear. What you SHOULD say.

STAGE 1 WHAT YOU SAY

"Hi Sandra, it's Phil from Marketing Sweet, how are you?"

Surface-level greeting. Polite. Generic.

STAGE 2 WHAT THEY HEAR

"He wants to sell me something. I've got 10,000 things to do. How do I get him off the phone?"

Internal monologue. The buyer's defences fire instantly.

STAGE 3 WHAT YOU SHOULD SAY

"I've got some really interesting findings about your website — I think you're the perfect person to send them to."

Breaks the script. Implies value. Respects the buyer.

04 · THE HACK

Be Correctable

Exploit the human desire to be right.

THE PRINCIPLE

People love being right. Correcting someone is a small pleasure. Make small, easily-correctable statements — the correction is the information you wanted.

REP "You must be paying around \$100 to \$200, would I be right?"

BUYER Buyer corrects: "Actually it's \$700."

→ **You have the price.**

REP "You're the perfect person to speak to about this."

BUYER Receptionist corrects: "Actually, you need Bob."

→ **You have the buyer's name.**

REP "I think you must be the operations manager?"

BUYER They correct: "No, I'm the owner."

→ **You know their role.**

THE RULE

Be correctable on small low-stakes claims (price, role, name). NEVER be correctable on the buyer's pain or the product's value — those are where you have to be right.

05 · THE RESPECT RULE

Reception = the Boss's Partner

If you ignore the partner, you don't get invited back.

THE ANALOGY

You visit a mate's house. He has a partner. If you walk in, ignore the partner, and only talk to your mate — you'll get past the front door once. You won't be invited back.

THE OFFICE WORKS THE SAME WAY

Reception has the role at work that the partner has at home. They're who the boss actually consults when no-one's watching.

THE SILENT TORPEDO

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|----------------|--|
| Week 1 | Rep dismisses receptionist. Gets through to owner. Pitches well. |
| Week 1 | Owner says "let me come back to you." |
| Week 1 | Owner asks receptionist what she thought. |
| Week 4 | Deal doesn't close. Rep blames price / timing / product. |
| Reality | The 30-second exchange in week 1 killed it. Rep never knew. |

CORIE

"If you treat her like she's in your way, you might get past her. But when the boss is floating around the office — who does he actually talk to? Treat her as the partner. Because that's what she is."

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

THE MINDSET

- ◆ Drop the word "gatekeeper" from your vocabulary today.
- ◆ The cold call is the party. Go looking for your one person.
- ◆ Hard now, easy later. Punch the right hole.

THE OPENER

- ◆ "I think you're the perfect person to speak to about this."
- ◆ "Have you heard of Marketing Sweet before?" — opens a gap.
- ◆ Replace "is the owner there?" with both of the above.

THE TECHNIQUE

- ◆ Be correctable on small things — price, role, name.
- ◆ Run every line through Stage 2: what is the buyer hearing?
- ◆ Trial close before asking for the deal: "is there anything I haven't covered?"

THE PRINCIPLE

- ◆ Reception is the boss's partner. Treat her that way.
- ◆ Don't say dumb things. That's most of the job.
- ◆ Follow the process — your gut about who'll buy is wildly unreliable.

THERE IS NO GATEKEEPER · WHOEVER PICKS UP IS THE PERFECT PERSON · BE KIND